Capgemini

MICROSOFT COWORK ENABLEMENT CAMP

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1 Quick summary

The main message from the training was that **Cowork is aimed at completing outcome-based, multi-step work**, rather than only helping a user one prompt at a time. It can use organizational context, choose skills or plugins, work across Microsoft 365 applications, create artifacts, and pause for user approval when an action needs permission.

Area	What was covered
Day 1	Cowork value proposition, functional scenarios, Work IQ, skills, plugins and hands-on use cases.
Day 2	FinOps, forecasting credit usage, cost control, Analytics Hub, billing approaches and partner/service opportunities.
Hands-on examples	Create an interactive sales dashboard from SharePoint data, draft an email with attachment, post/share outputs, and create Planner tasks from prior context.
Control points	Access depends on available data and permissions. Actions across apps may require approval. Credit usage can be reviewed after execution.

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2 Day 1 notes

2.1 Chat vs Cowork

Simple analogy from the notes: Chat is like driving the car with Copilot as navigator. Cowork is like giving the destination to a chauffeur, while still approving important decisions.

- Chat helps step by step. Cowork works toward the end goal and handles more of the planning and execution.
- Cowork can queue work and execute some activities in parallel instead of making the user wait for every step to finish.
- The user can see tracked tasks, steer the work, review sources and ask for changes in the same chat.

2.2 Core building blocks

Building block	What it meant in the session
Work IQ	The organizational knowledge and context used to ground the task, such as role, recent work, people, documents and relationships.
Skills	Reusable instructions that describe what needs to be done and how it should be done. The screenshots referred to SKILL.md and building reusable skills.
Plugins	The connection to tools, systems and actions. The session examples included Microsoft 365 applications and references to Microsoft-built and partner plugins.

- A good skill is expected to reduce repeated briefing, apply consistent standards and make a repeatable workflow shareable with the team.
- The personal notes specifically caution against downloading skills from Reddit or unsecured websites.
- The session also noted that Defender can identify issues in skills.

2.3 Capabilities discussed

Capability	Plain-language takeaway
Multi-step reasoning	Cowork can break a goal into a plan and execute the steps.
Parallel tasks	Some work can continue at the same time, such as creating an artifact while preparing an email draft.
Rich artifacts	The examples included HTML, PNG and document outputs.
Cross-source grounding	It can use available organizational sources instead of relying only on the prompt.
Multi-app execution	The demos covered SharePoint, Outlook, Teams, OneDrive and Planner.
Steering and approvals	The user can adjust the work, and permission gates are shown before certain actions.

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2.4 Functional scenarios

The screenshots grouped scenarios across business functions. Examples visible in the notes included:

Function	Example scenarios shown
Executive / leadership	Inbox triage, board pre-reads, leadership briefs, meeting synthesis and decision briefings.
Sales	Meeting preparation and follow-up, RFP responses, pitch/proposal work, account research, pipeline analysis, renewal preparation and customer onboarding.
Marketing	Branded content, launch kits, messaging documents, performance readouts, campaign work and customer insight synthesis.
Customer service	Root-cause diagnosis, knowledge refinement, stalled-case outreach, escalation handoff and voice-of-customer synthesis.
Finance and operations	Close/variance packages, business reviews, reconciliation, audit evidence, RFP response support and procurement work.
Legal	Playbook-based contract work, drafting from precedent and key-term extraction.

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3 Day 2 notes

3.1 Main agenda

Topic	What was captured
Day 1 recap and FinOps introduction	Transition from building Cowork solutions to understanding consumption and operating cost.
Multi-tenant cost controlling	A click-by-click user research/session topic was listed in the agenda.
FinOps I	Forecast usage, model cost, build a consumption plan and use a cost calculator.
Cowork value reporting	Use of Copilot Analytics Hub for adoption, value, cost and opportunity views.
FinOps II	Design billing that fits the organization.

3.2 FinOps

- The notes distinguish everyday AI and agentic AI when discussing billing and usage.
- The training focused on forecasting usage, setting a credit range, estimating cost, budgeting, allocation, governance and ongoing optimization.
- The customers gets ROI visibility, budgets and consumption transparency before scaling.
- The material positioned FinOps both as an upfront strategy activity and as an ongoing managed service.
- The notes captured that usage-based billing creates ongoing advisory and managed-service demand, not only initial implementation work.
- A screenshot stated that 1 credit equals $0.01 in the PAYG plan. This is recorded only as presented in the session material and should be validated against current official pricing before customer use.

3.3 Copilot Analytics Hub

- Analytics Hub was shown as a place to understand adoption, value, cost and emerging opportunities across usage-based AI services.
- The captured materials referred to usage and cost views across users and groups, including where consumption is concentrated.
- The notes included a contact for Analytics Hub and a public Analytics Hub resource link.

3.4 Items noted as in progress or follow-up

- The personal notes state that the Microsoft Business Leader App was in progress and would be available for general use. No release date was captured.
- The training account/license was noted as available until the end of the week.
- A request was captured to include the note owner and PDM on the UBB/Consumption directory template communication.

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4 What stood out from an architecture point of view

These are direct takeaways from the demonstrated behavior, not additional product assumptions:

Observation	Why it matters
Source access drives the result	Grounding works only when the required content exists and the user/Cowork has access to it.
Skills make work repeatable	A reusable instruction set can standardize how a recurring task is handled across users.
Plugins/connectors extend execution	They allow Cowork to reach applications and perform actions, but tenant approval and governance are important.
Human approval remains part of the flow	The demo showed approval gates before Graph-backed actions were performed in Teams/Planner.
Context can be reused	Keeping the same chat allows later tasks to build on prior sources, artifacts and analysis.
Consumption needs operational governance	Day 2 focused on forecasting, budgets, reporting and billing, showing that cost management needs to be planned with the solution.
Security of shared skills matters	The explicit warning about untrusted skill downloads and Defender checks indicates a need for controlled skill sourcing and review.

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5 Useful resources captured in the notes

- **Copilot Adoption Dashboards | Analytics Hub:** https://microsoft.github.io/Analytics-Hub/
- **Govern Copilot Credit Consumption:** https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-copilot-studio/guidance/govern-credit-consumption
- **Cost Control & Governance article:** https://microsoft.github.io/mcscatblog/posts/copilot-harness-cost-governance/
- **Copilot Credits API article:** https://microsoft.github.io/mcscatblog/posts/copilot-credit-consumption-api/

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